

MARKET INTELLIGENCE REPORT

TrustMRR Startup Benchmarking Report

Category-level revenue, growth, and valuation signals across 1,000 startups — built to guide sourcing and screening priorities.

Data source: **TrustMRR platform snapshot, frozen 30 July 2026**

Scope: **1,000 startups · 29 metrics · revenue, MRR, growth, geography, valuation**

Prepared for internal investment review

Five Signals That Should Shape the Screen



\$134M / \$13.5M

Aggregate trailing-12-month revenue and combined MRR across the full 1,000-startup universe — a broad but extremely long-tailed base.



Top 1% = 48% of MRR

Just 10 startups capture nearly half of all monthly recurring revenue. This is a power-law market — returns will concentrate in outliers, not the median deal.



SaaS Grows Fastest, AI Dominates Volume

AI is the largest category by count (197 startups) but SaaS posts the strongest average 30-day MRR growth (+64%). Scale and momentum are not the same signal.



3.0x Median Revenue Multiple

Across 215 priced, on-sale startups, asking prices cluster at 1.7x–6.0x trailing revenue (25th–75th pctl) — a usable comp range for acquisition-style deals.



Mobile Apps: Highest Liquidity, Weakest Momentum

56% of Mobile Apps startups are listed for sale (vs. 26% overall) but only 10% show positive MRR growth — a value/roll-up profile, not a growth bet.

What This Data Is — and Isn't



SCOPE

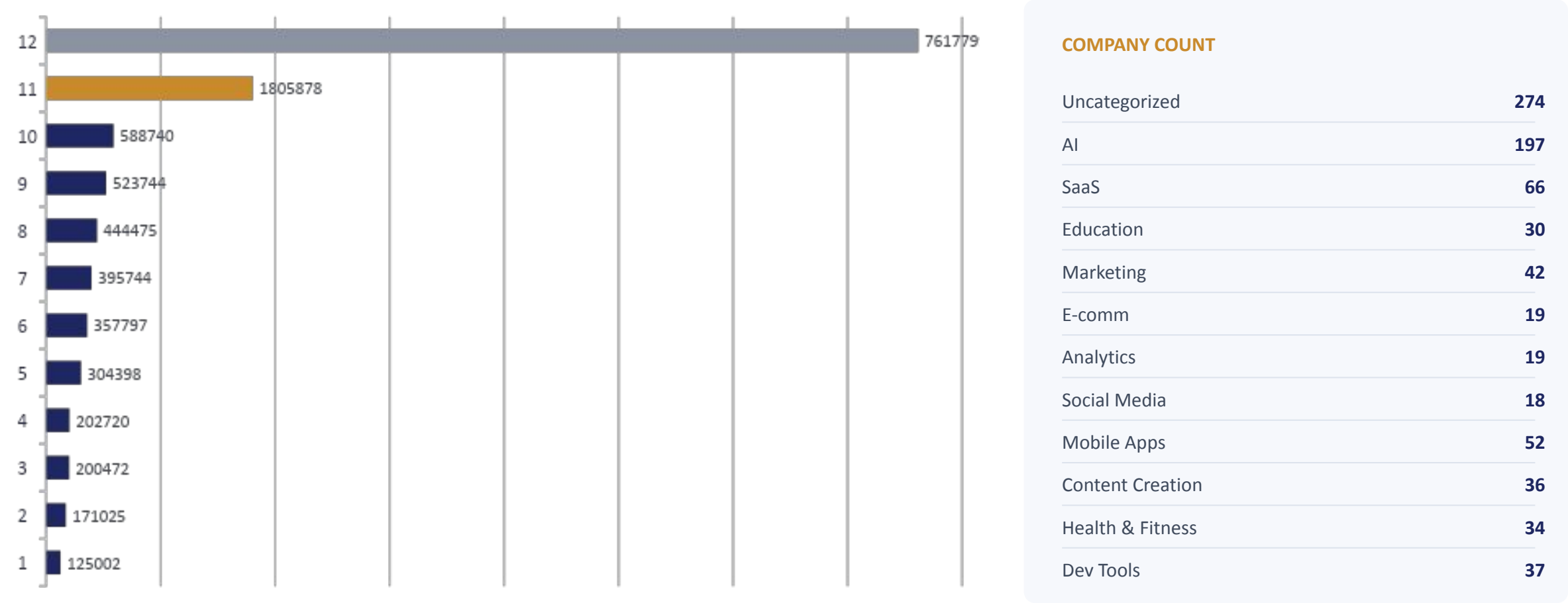
- 1,000 startups tracked on the TrustMRR platform, a market-intelligence service for startup revenue and MRR data
- 29 fields per company: revenue (30d / 3m / 12m / all-time), MRR, growth rates, subscriptions, category, geography, pricing model, and — where listed — asking price and revenue multiple
- Snapshot frozen 30 July 2026; figures are self-reported by founders / connected via payment-provider APIs (Stripe, RevenueCat, etc.)



READ WITH CAUTION

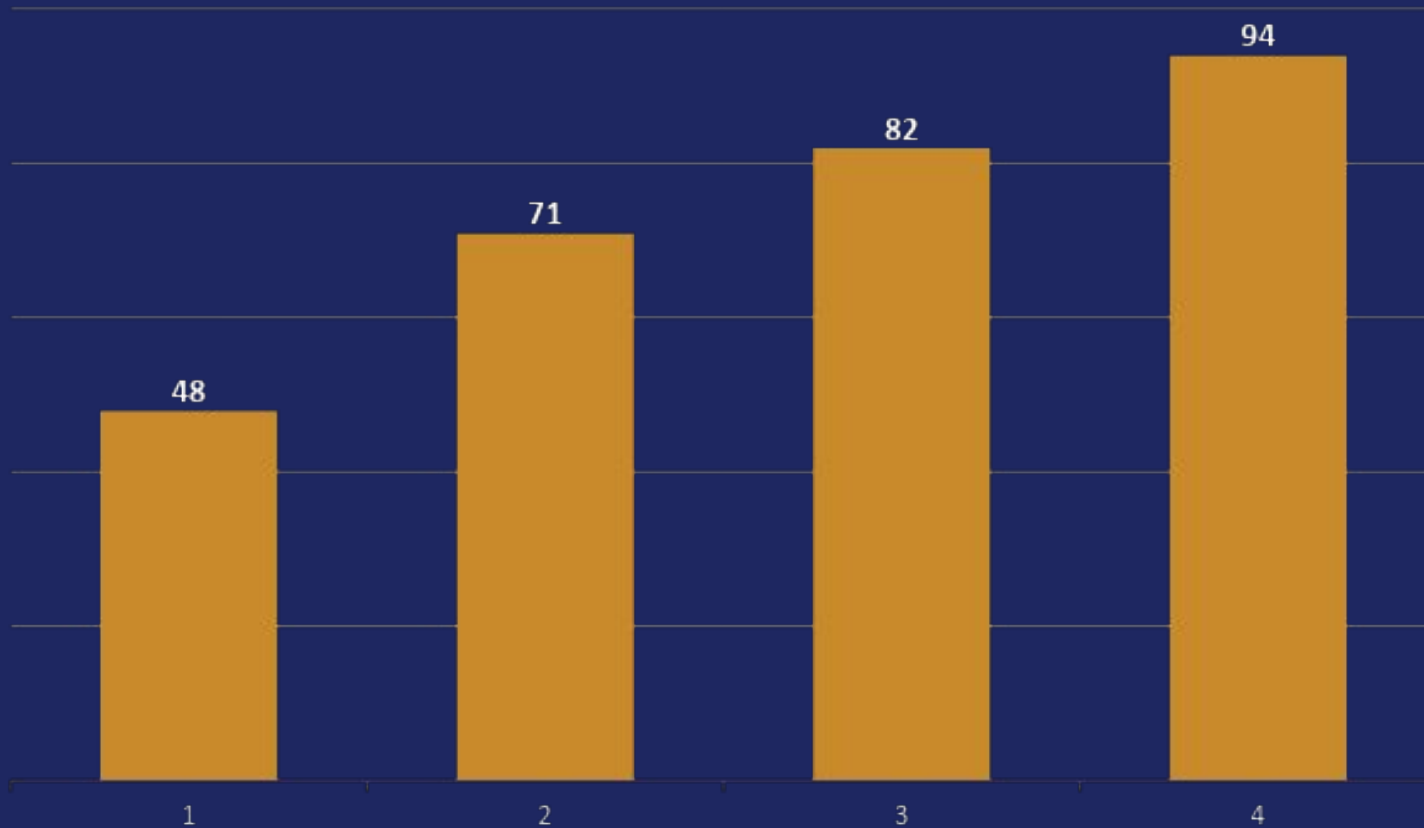
- 27% of startups carry no category tag — this “Uncategorized” group is the single largest bucket by revenue, so category benchmarks below cover ~73% of the base
- Country is unknown for 24% of records; growth rate is unavailable for 11%
- MRR growth is heavily right-skewed by a handful of extreme movers (range: -74% to +hundreds%) — averages overstate typical performance
- Revenue multiples exist for only 215 of 1,000 startups (the priced subset of the 262 listed for sale) — directional comps, not a full market

Where the Revenue Actually Sits, by Category



*Uncategorized = largest revenue bucket but carries no category tag; treat as a data-quality flag, not a market segment.

A Power-Law Market: Returns Will Live in the Tail



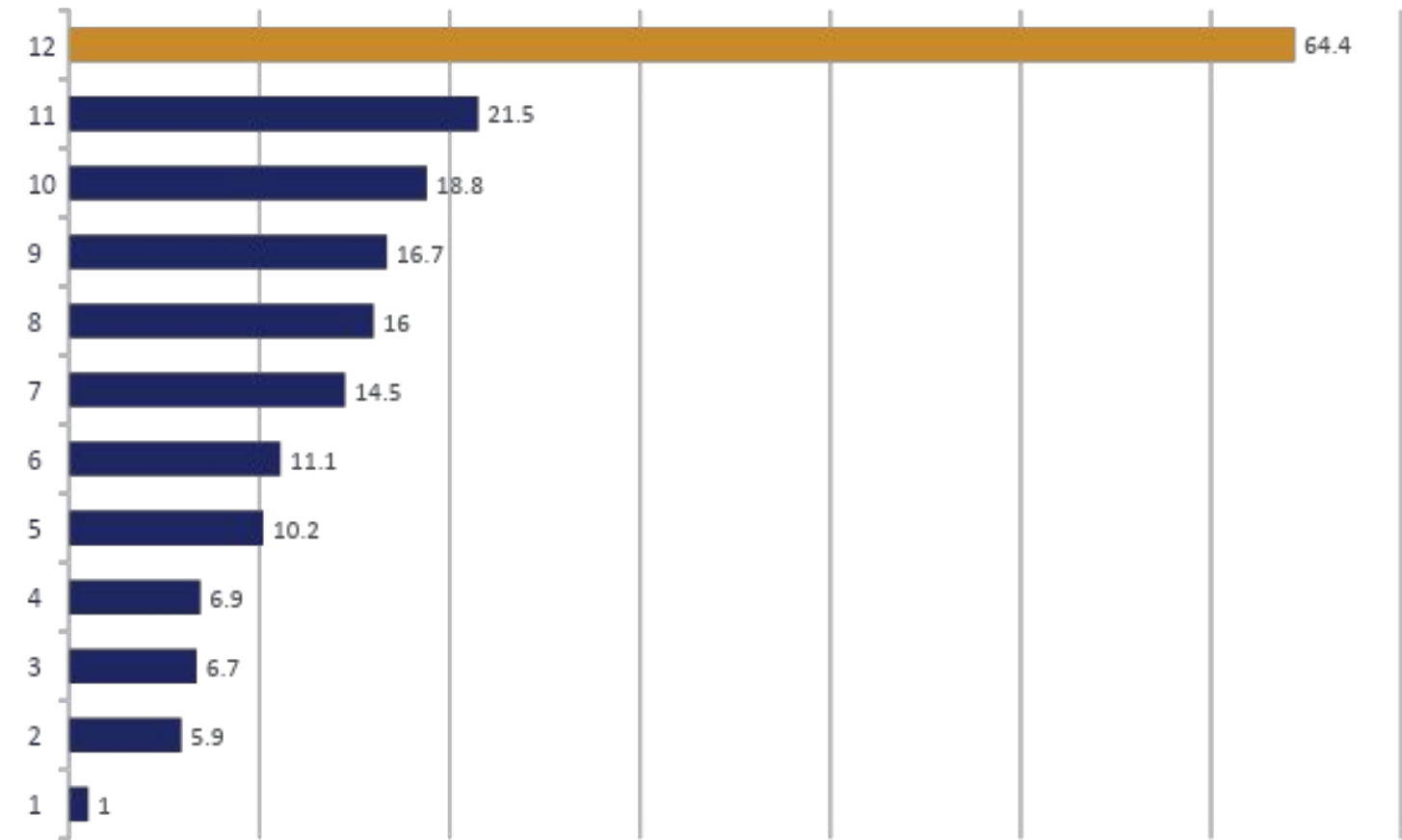
48%

of all monthly recurring revenue in this dataset is generated by just 10 startups.

IMPLICATION

Sourcing volume matters less than identifying the small set of category leaders — broad, shallow diligence across many small deals is unlikely to move fund returns.

Average 30-Day MRR Growth by Category



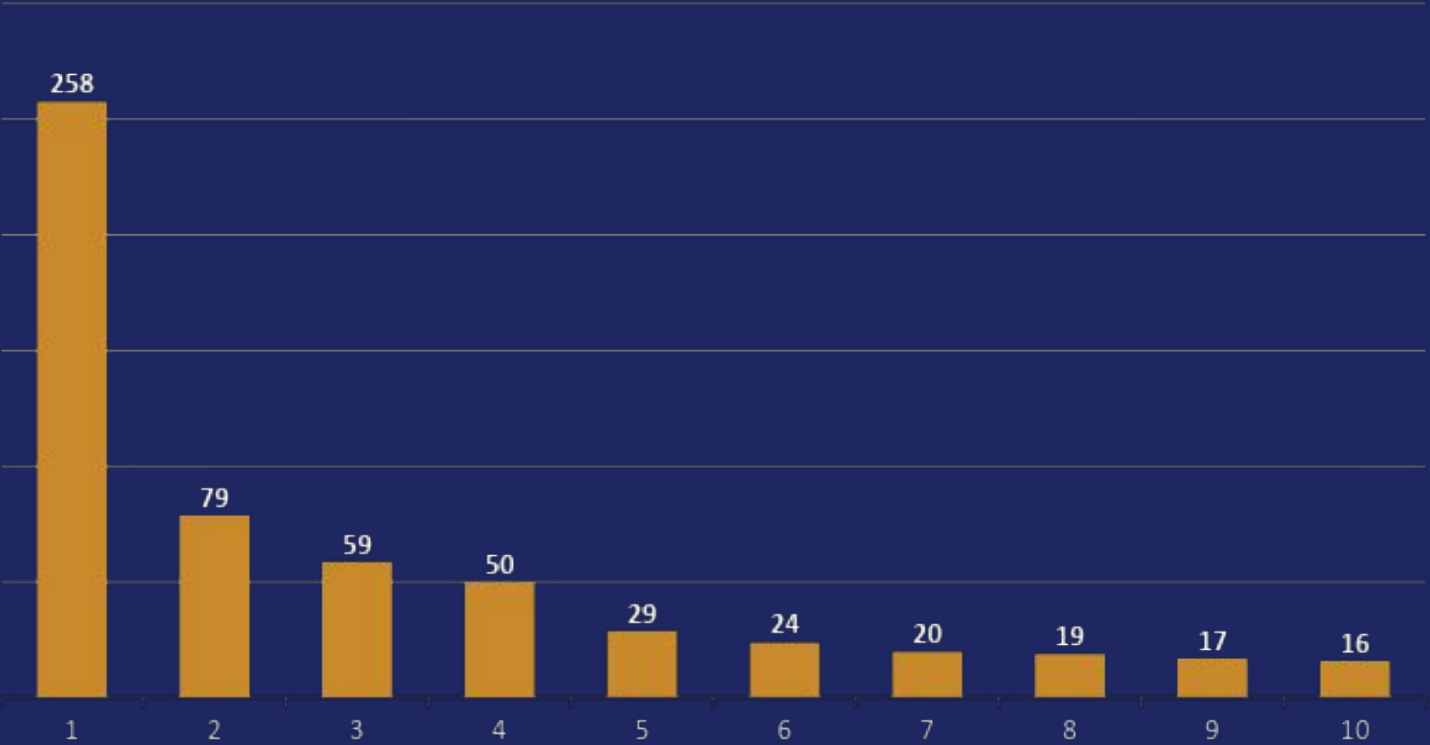
READ THE AVERAGE CAREFULLY

Growth is right-skewed — a few outliers pull category averages up while most startups sit flat. The share of startups actually growing tells a different story:

% OF STARTUPS WITH POSITIVE 30D MRR GROWTH

Dev Tools	54%
Marketing	48%
Analytics	47%
Fintech	47%
AI	26%
Mobile Apps	10%

The Base Is US-Anchored With a Long International Tail



Startup count by HQ country (top 10 of the 76% with a known country)

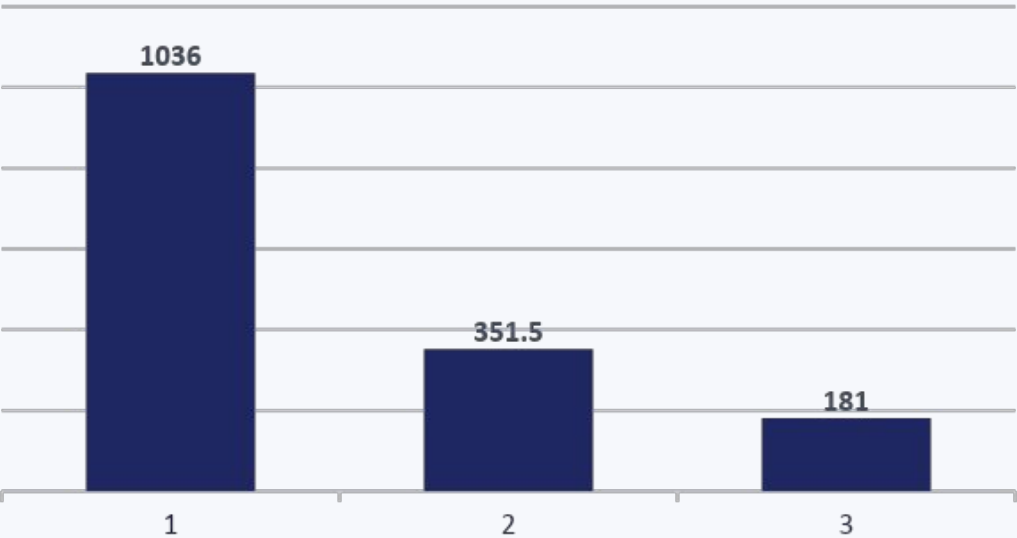
56%

of all combined MRR in the dataset (\$7.5M of \$13.5M) sits with US startups — the clear revenue center of gravity despite being just 26% of the count.

France and India lead the international tail by count, but at far lower median MRR — signals of earlier-stage markets rather than comparable scale.

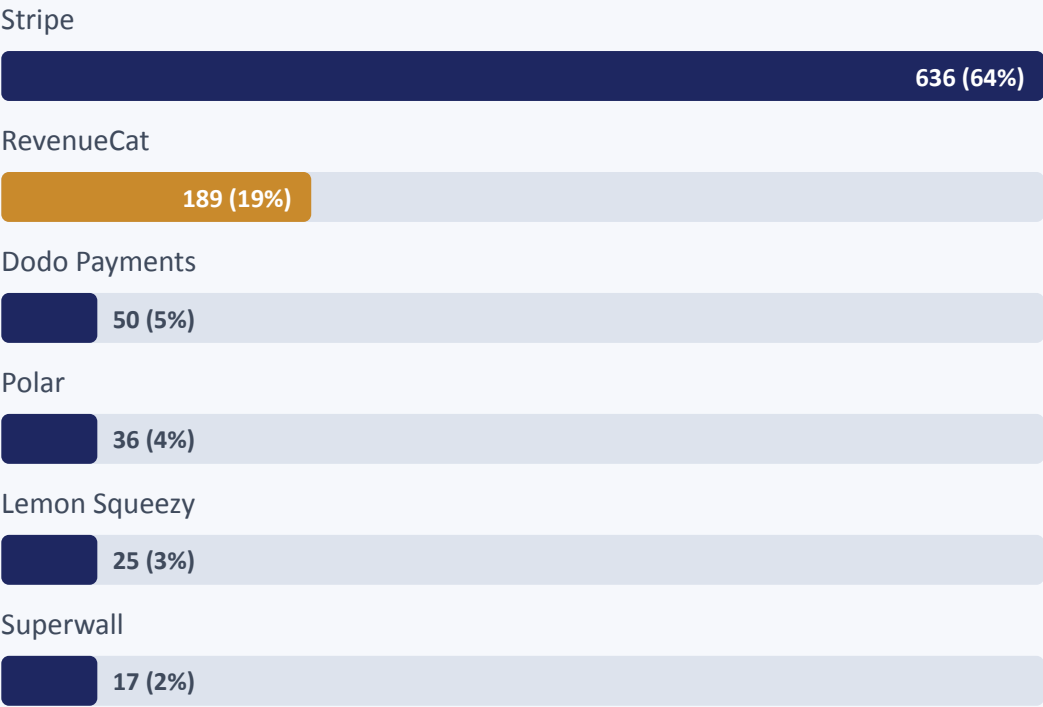
B2B Commands Revenue; Monetization Is Mobile-Heavy

MEDIAN MRR BY AUDIENCE



B2B startups post 5.7x the median MRR of B2C peers (288 records have no audience tag and are excluded).

MONETIZATION RAILS (TOP 6)



63.6% run on Stripe (web-first SaaS billing). RevenueCat — native mobile in-app-purchase infrastructure — powers 18.9%, roughly matching the Mobile Apps category footprint.

Comps for Acquisition-Style Entry, From Listed Asking Prices

MEDIAN MULTIPLE

3.0x

trailing revenue, across 215 priced startups listed for sale

25th percentile

1.7x

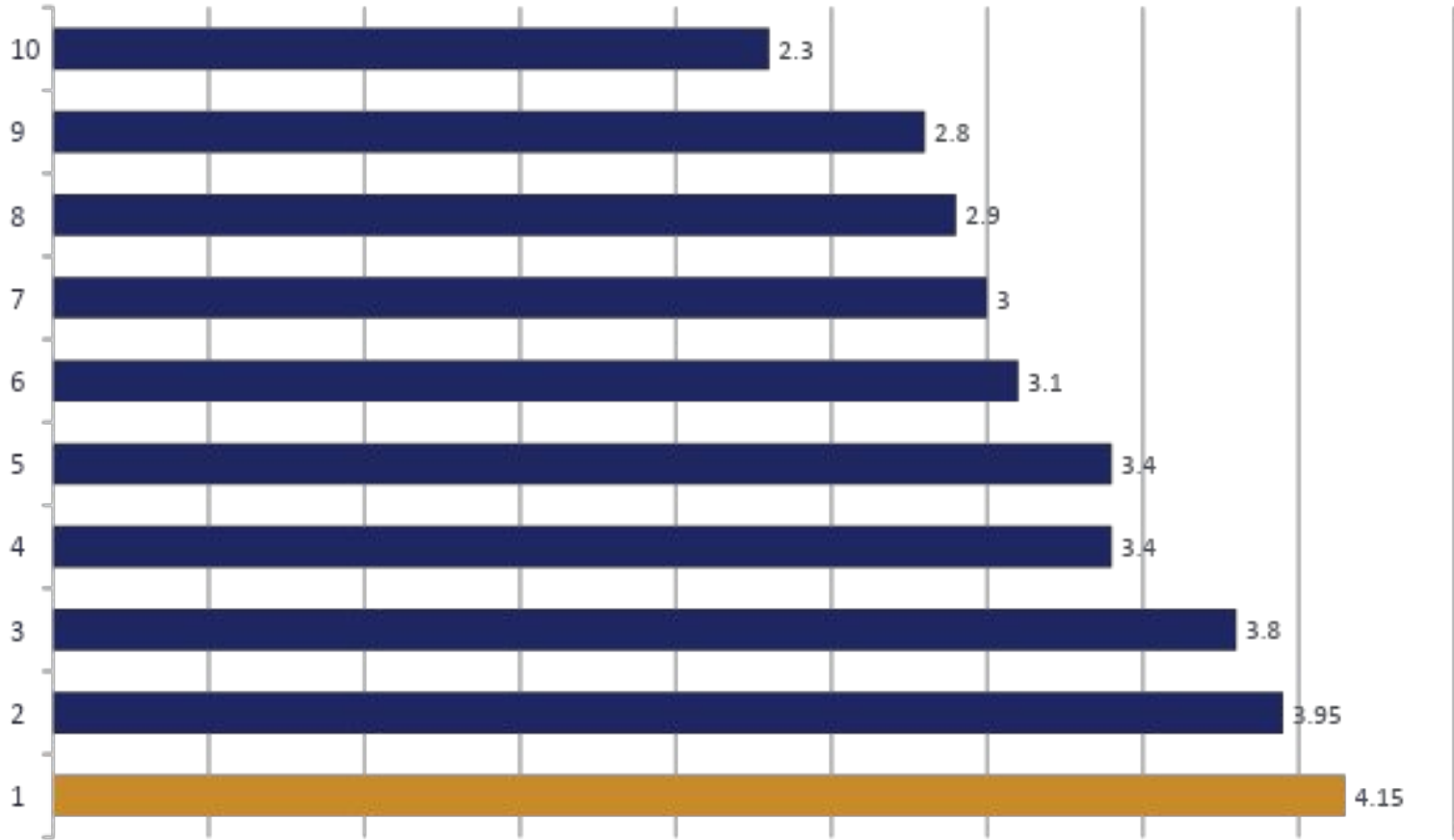
75th percentile

6.0x

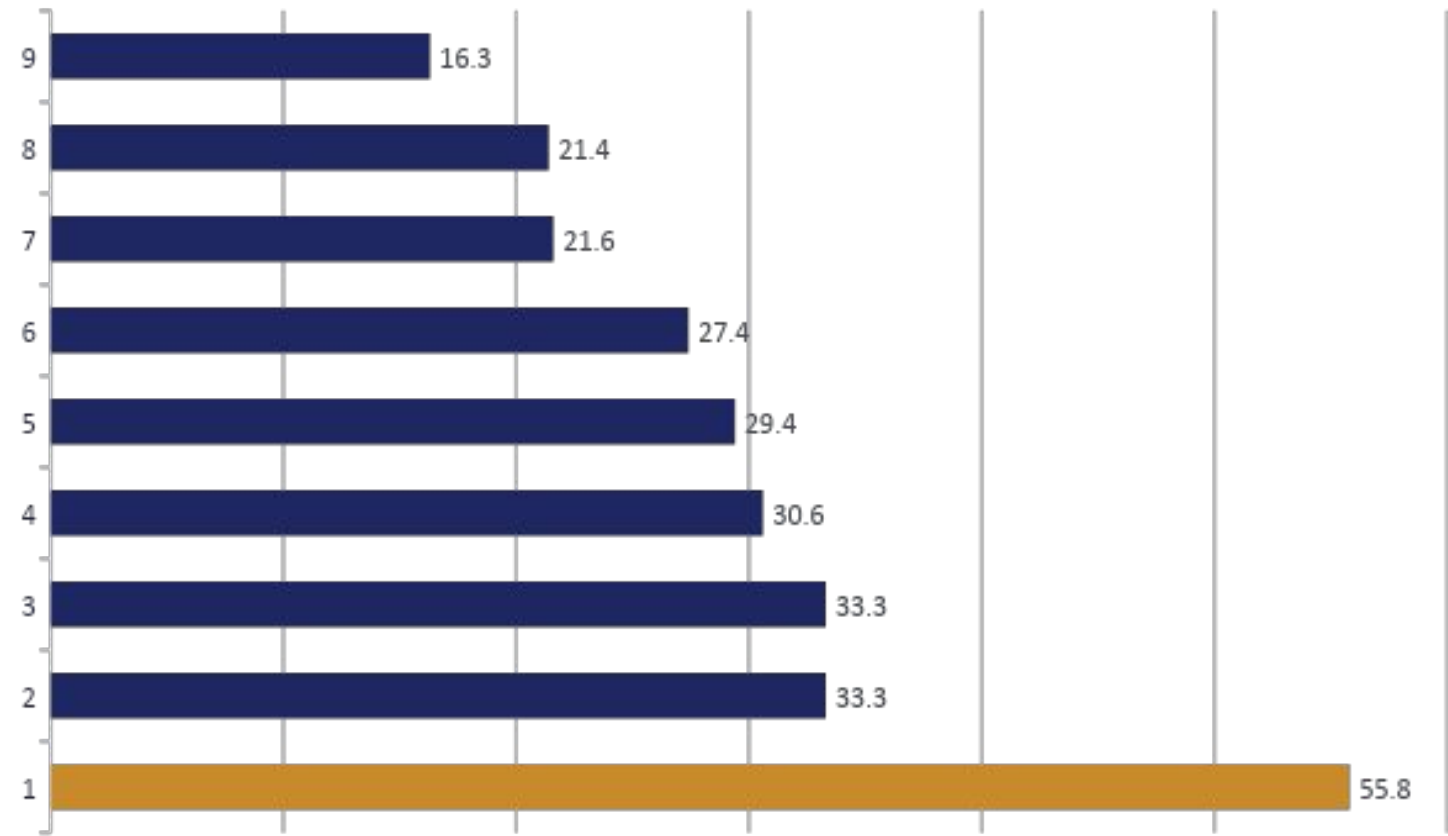
90th percentile

11.1x

Outliers run as high as 326x on pre-revenue or nominal-revenue listings — exclude sub-\$1k-revenue asks from any comp set.



Share of Each Category Currently Listed for Sale



Dataset average: 26.2% of all 1,000 startups are listed for sale

READING THIS ALONGSIDE GROWTH

Mobile Apps combine the highest sale-listing rate (56%) with the lowest growth consistency (10% positive, Slide 6) — a classic value/roll-up profile: cash-flowing, plentiful, but not compounding on their own.

By contrast, SaaS and Education pair above-average liquidity (33%) with above-average growth — the more attractive combination for an active acquire-and-grow strategy.

What This Screen Cannot Tell You — Diligence Before Capital



Unaudited, Self-Reported Figures

Revenue and MRR come from founder-connected payment APIs, not audited financials. Verify bank/processor statements directly before underwriting any specific name.



Vanity Metrics Don't Predict Revenue

X/Twitter follower count shows ~0 correlation with revenue or MRR ($r = 0.03$) in this dataset. Don't let social proof substitute for unit-economics diligence.



Small, Self-Selected Valuation Sample

The 3.0x median multiple is drawn from 215 startups that chose to list — 21.5% of the base. Founders selling into a soft category may under- or over-price relative to true market.



Growth Averages Are Outlier-Driven

30-day MRR growth swings from -74% to over +300% inside single categories. Screen individual deals on trend consistency and cohort retention, not one 30-day print.



Snapshot, Not a Time Series

This is a single frozen date (30 Jul 2026). Re-pull and re-run this benchmarking screen quarterly to catch category rotation early.

Where This Screen Points the Fund



Go Deep, Not Wide

The power-law concentration (Slide 5) means sourcing volume matters less than conviction on category leaders. Prioritize a shortlist of outlier candidates over broad small-check spraying.



Treat the AI Premium With Scrutiny

AI commands the highest valuation multiple (4.15x) but among the lowest growth-consistency rates (26% positive). Underwrite AI deals on defensibility and retention — not category momentum alone.



Favor B2B and Hybrid Models

B2B startups post 5.7x the median MRR of B2C peers. All else equal, weight sourcing toward B2B / “both” audience models for revenue durability.



Use Mobile Apps as a Roll-Up, Not a Growth Thesis

Highest sale-listing rate (56%) but weakest growth consistency (10%) — fits an acquire-and-optimize strategy better than a venture-growth bet.



Institutionalize the Re-Screen

Re-run this category benchmark each time TrustMRR refreshes, and pair it with direct financial verification before any term sheet.